UNLOCKING YOUR COGNITIVE POTENTIAL

AN INTRODUCTION TO FEUERSTEIN INSTRUMENTAL ENRICHMENT (FIE) METHOD

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The human brain is the world's most complex system.

The living brain is actually "neuroplastic" (its "circuits" are constantly changing in response to what we actually do out in the world (form, unform and reform).

-Norman Doidge, University of Toronto, Feb. 2015.

Basic principle of the Feuerstein Method is that all of us – regardless of our age, disability or socio-economic background – have the ability to significantly improve our level of cognitive functioning, our IQ, and the way we learn.

By identifying and targeting specific cognitive weaknesses, we can intervene and strengthen the weak cognitive capacities that affect our learning. We can ‘re-design’ our brains.

Sunday News Story:
http://tvnz.co.nz/sunday-news-approach-dyslexia-learning-video-6052374

Reuven Feuerstein, born in Romania in 1921. An Israeli clinical, developmental, and cognitive psychologist. Renowned for his theory of intelligence which states “ it is not ‘fixed’, but modifiable (able to be developed)”. Reuven passed on in Israel, 29 April 2014.

Feuerstein’s Instrumental Enrichment (FIE) – is the educational application of Feuerstein’s cognitive development programme. The FIE programmes consist for the most part, structured paper-and-pencil exercises (340 pages).

The FIE programme corrects deficiencies in fundamental thinking skills and provides students with the concepts, skills, and strategies necessary to function as independent learners.

Learn how to

THE THEORY OF STRUCTURAL COGNITIVE MODIFIABILITY (SCM)

Modifiability means having the ability to adapt, to alter, and to regulate.

Cognitive relates to the ability to think, reason, and learn.

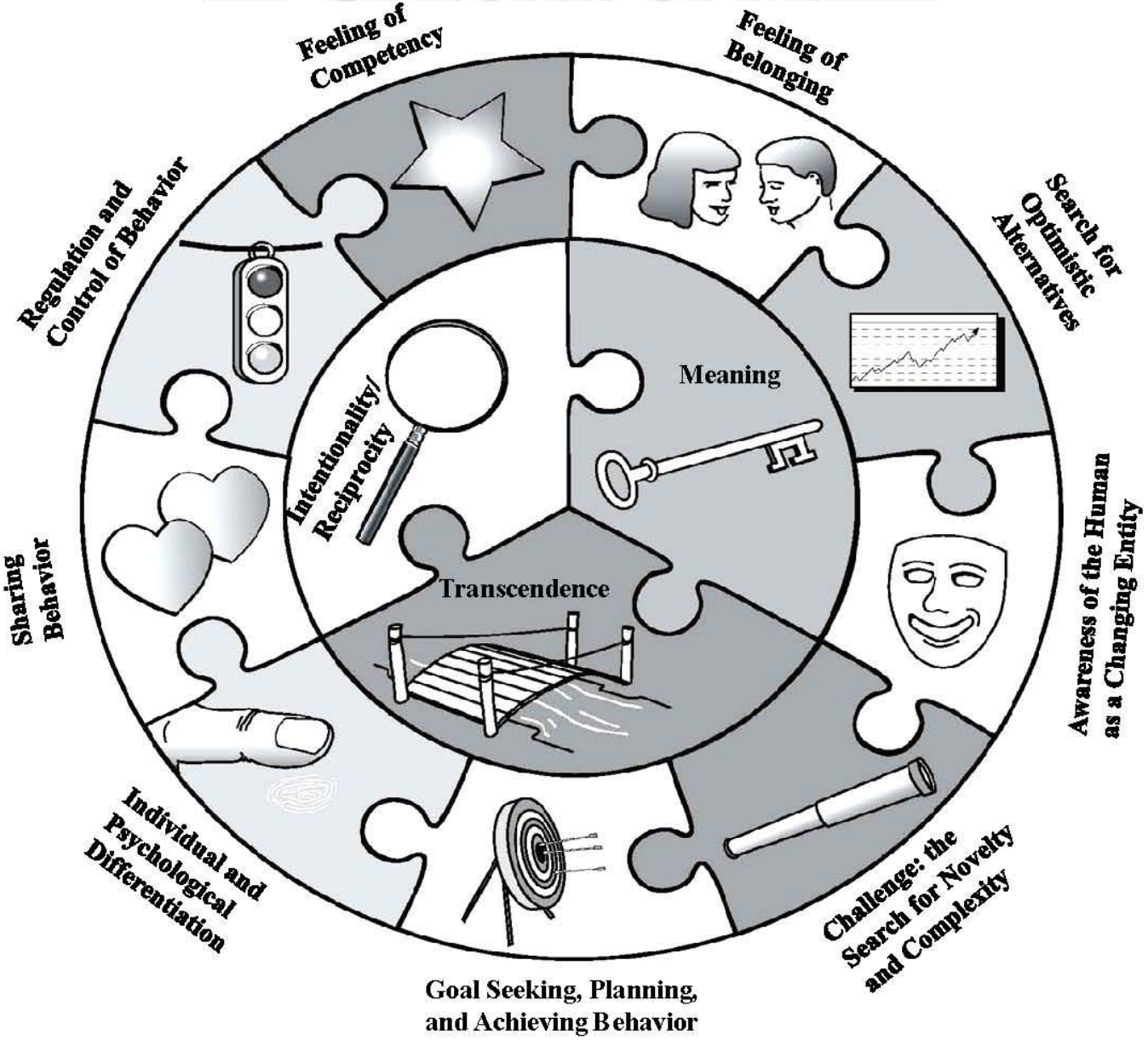
Structural involves organization and integration of the components that make up our thinking.

Mediated Learning Experience (MLE)

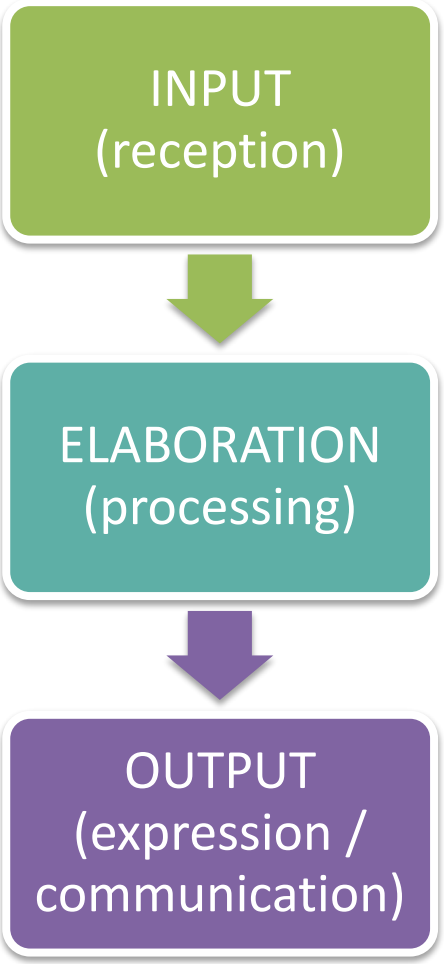
Feuerstein's (1980) criteria of MLE provide the mediator with techniques that help mediate the skill of scaffolding.

- Understanding bullying.
- Instill in the learner the belief that there is the potential for resolution and that perhaps through restorative justice process both parties (bully and victim) can move to different ways of interaction (search for an optimistic alternative).
- The mediator can show them how in reflecting on the reason behind the bullying, there is the opportunity for a different reality (mediating self-change).

12 Criteria of MLE



Cognitive Functions



These **phases** give a framework for targeting specific skills needed to ensure the steps in understanding and resolving bullying are effective.

- **Capacity to consider more than one source of information at the input phase**: clear communication of the different points of view.
- **Accurate definition of the problem, adequate elaboration of cognitive categories at the elaboration phase:** situation described carefully, background behind the feelings and actions explored and the context explained.
- **Mature, participatory, and worked-through response at the output phase:** care needs to be taken to avoid emotional outbursts and blocking behavior as well as egocentric or one-sided perspective of the situation.

Cognitive Functions and Dysfunctions

INPUT

Functions		Dysfunctions
Clear	Perception	Blurred and Sweeping
Systematic	Exploration of a Learning Situation	Impulsive
Precise and Accurate	Receptive Verbal Tools and Concepts	Impaired
Well Developed	Understanding of Spatial Concepts	Impaired
Well Developed	Understanding of Temporal Concepts	Lack of or Impaired
Well Developed	Ability to Conserve Constancies	Impaired
Precise and Accurate	Data Gathering	Impaired
Well Developed	Capacity to Consider More Than One Source of Inspiration	Impaired

ELABORATION

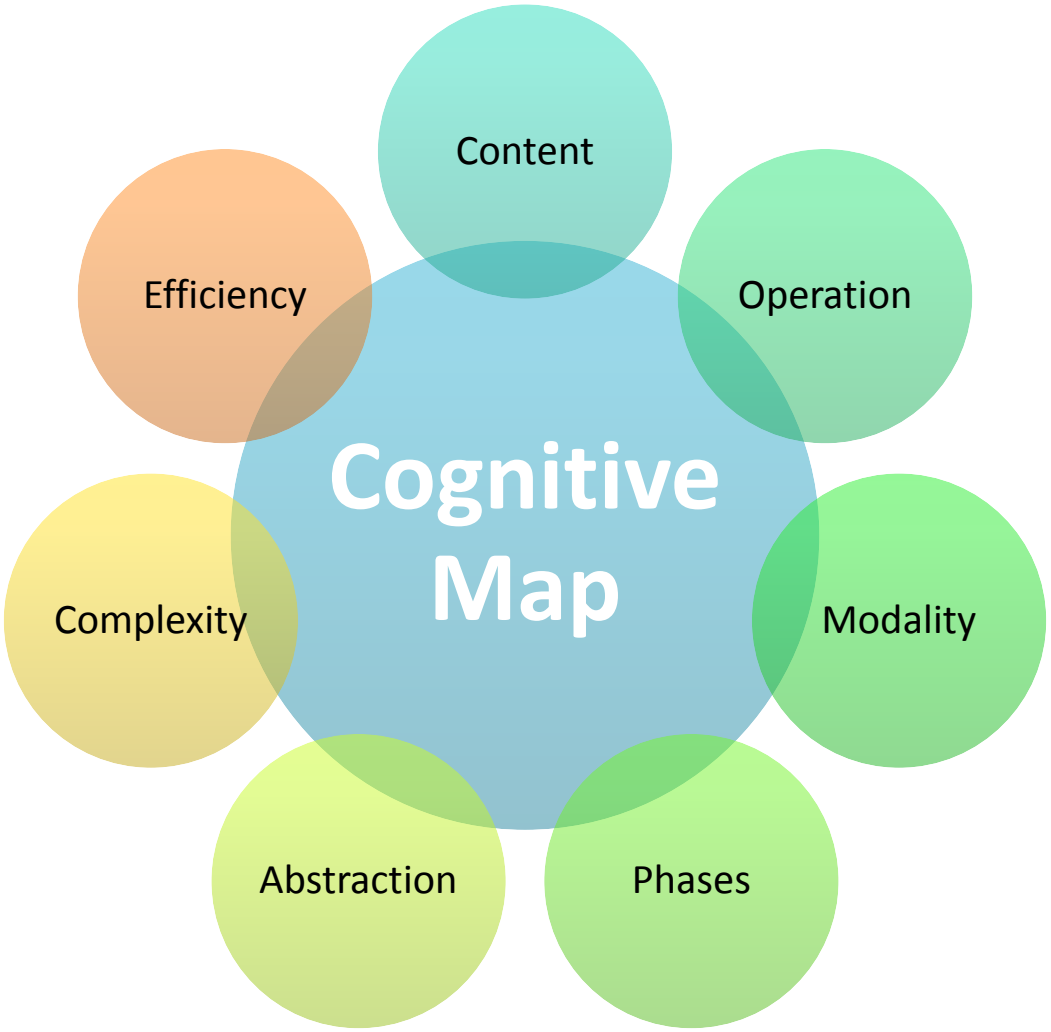
Functions		Dysfunctions
Accurate	Definition of the Problem	Inaccurate
Ability	Select Relevant Cues	Inability
Ability to	Engage in Spontaneous Comparative Behaviour	Inability to
Broad and Wide	Mental Field	Narrow and Limited
Need for	Spontaneous Summative Behaviour	Impaired Need for
Ability to	Project Virtual Relations	Inability to
Need for	Logical Evidence	Lack of Need for

ELABORATION (cont.)

Functions		Dysfunctions
Ability to	Internalize Events	Inability to
Ability to Use	Inferential- Hypothetical Thinking	Impaired Ability to Use
Ability to Use	Strategies for Hypothesis Testing	Impaired Ability to Use
Need for	Planning Behaviour	Lack of
Adequate	Elaboration of Cognitive Categories	Impaired
Meaningful	Grasp of Reality	Episodic

OUTPUT

Mature	Communication Modalities	Egocentric
Participatory	Output Responses	Blocking
Worked Through	Output Responses	Trial and Error
Adequate	Expressive Verbal Tools	Impaired
Precise and Accurate	Data output	Impaired
Accurate	Visual Transport	Impaired
Appropriate	Behaviour	Impulsive/Acting Out



The cognitive map can be used to analyse and manipulate the learning task to ensure that it is pitched at a meaningful and useful level for the learner.

THE DIFFERENCE BETWEEN MLE AND PARENTING AND TEACHING

MLE

Mediator (M) stations himself/herself between the stimulus (S) and the response (R) in such a way that the learner is given the necessary tools to cope with the stimulus and is able to interact with the stimulus gradually (increasing the level of difficulty).

Parenting/ Teaching

Teacher or parent (TP) frequently stations themselves in the learner's place and answers in his stead in order to demonstrate how the learner should cope with the stimulus or the situation presented.

MLE

Mediational interaction is designed to increase the mediatee's learning ability and the modifiability.

The criterion for the success of the mediational interaction experience is the modifiability of the learner and his or her ability to be an independent learner.

Parenting/ Teaching

TP role on the other hand, aims at transmitting as many skills and as much knowledge and information as possible, usually in response to specific content areas or tasks to be completed.

TP interaction measures its success by means of the learner's level of achievement in tests or mastery of specific tasks that indicate the extent to which the learner has absorbed the instruction.

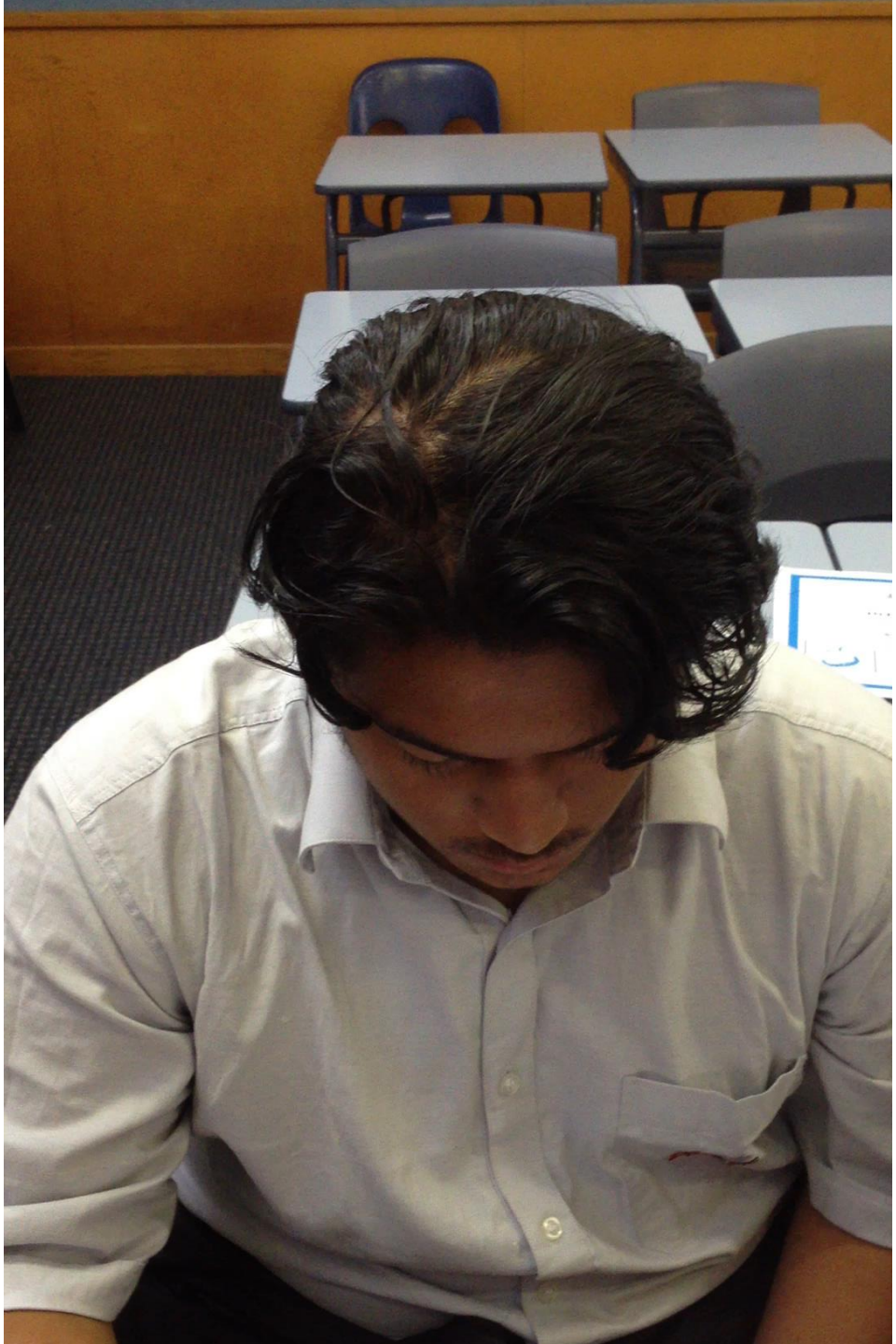
MLE

In the mediational interaction, the M brings the learner to the task, directs activity toward the solution, creates conditions that allow the learner to arrive independently at the correct answer, encourages successes, and reinforces feelings of competence. M prevents the learner from making mistakes and builds learning situations that are intended for success. M expends considerable efforts in developing the learning and thinking processes of the learner as well as an awareness of the processes occurring.

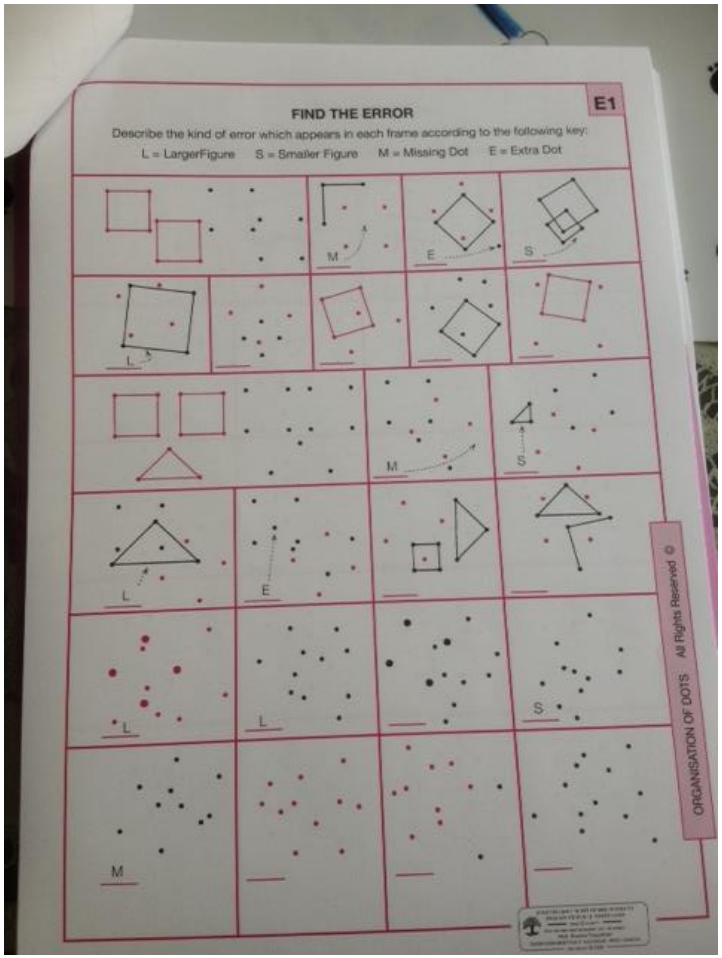
P / T: TP focuses on bringing the material to the learner, correcting incorrect responses, covering as much material as possible and producing correct answers or positive responses, and does not necessarily (or overtly) focus on the processes (strategies) used to arrive at them.

FIE Programmes

- Feuerstein Instrumental Enrichment Basic Level 1 and 2 (10 instruments): 4 to 8 yrs.
- FIE Standard Level 1, 2 and 3 (14 instruments): 9 yrs. and above to the elderly.
- Learning Potential Assessment Devices Level 1, 2 and 3 (14 instruments). Feuerstein Cognitive Assessor.
- Feuerstein Tactile Development for the Visually Challenged and students with ADHD.



ORGANISATION OF DOTS



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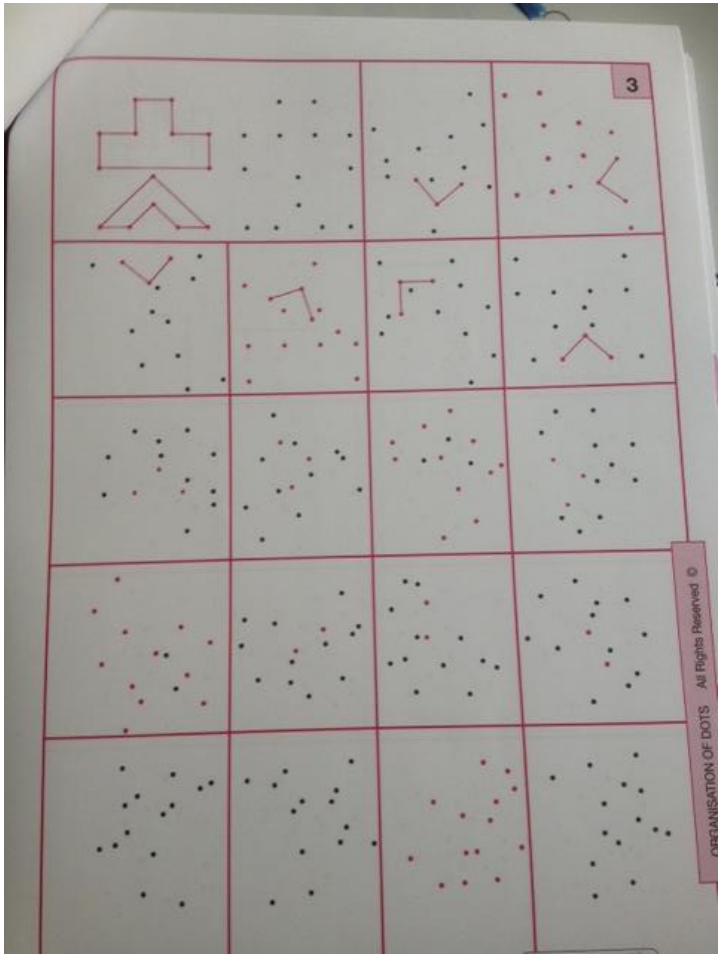
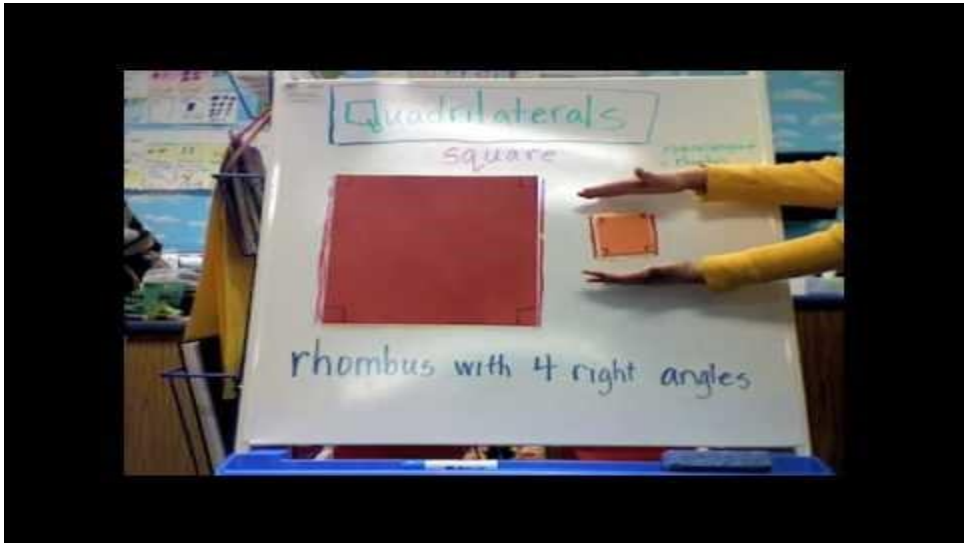
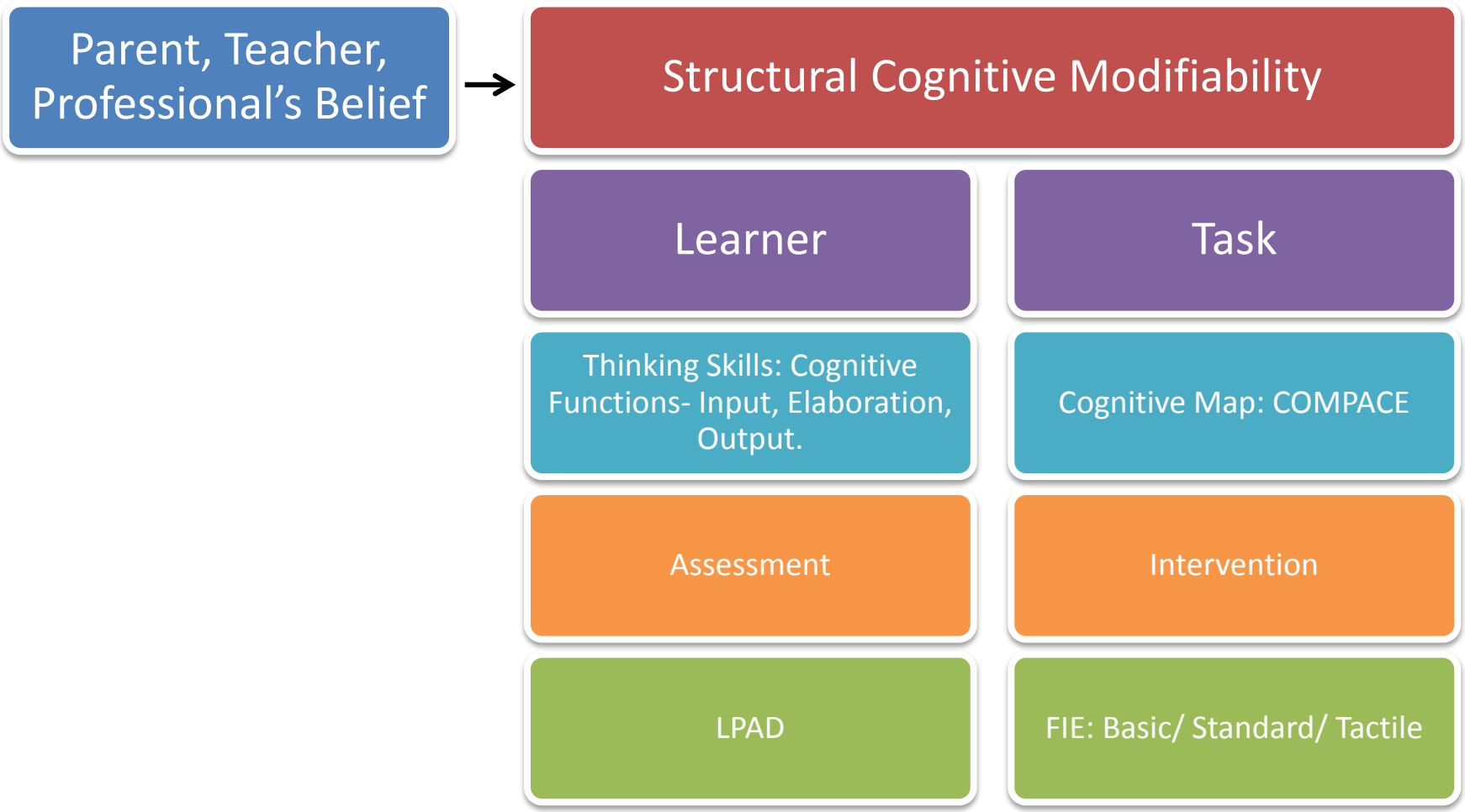


What is a square?



What is a scalene triangle

Feuerstein's Theory and Practice



FIE RESEARCH…

- International Centre For The Enhancement Of Learning Potential, ICELP, Jerusalem, Israel. www.icelp.info
- Delivered for 60 years in 40 countries in 85 training faculties.
- More than 3,000 published, case-studies, peer-reviewed independent research articles.
- Not-For-Profit
- Transforms lives of the brain injured, learning difficulties, normative and gifted children.

Feuerstein in New Zealand:

(www.nzfeuerstein.org)

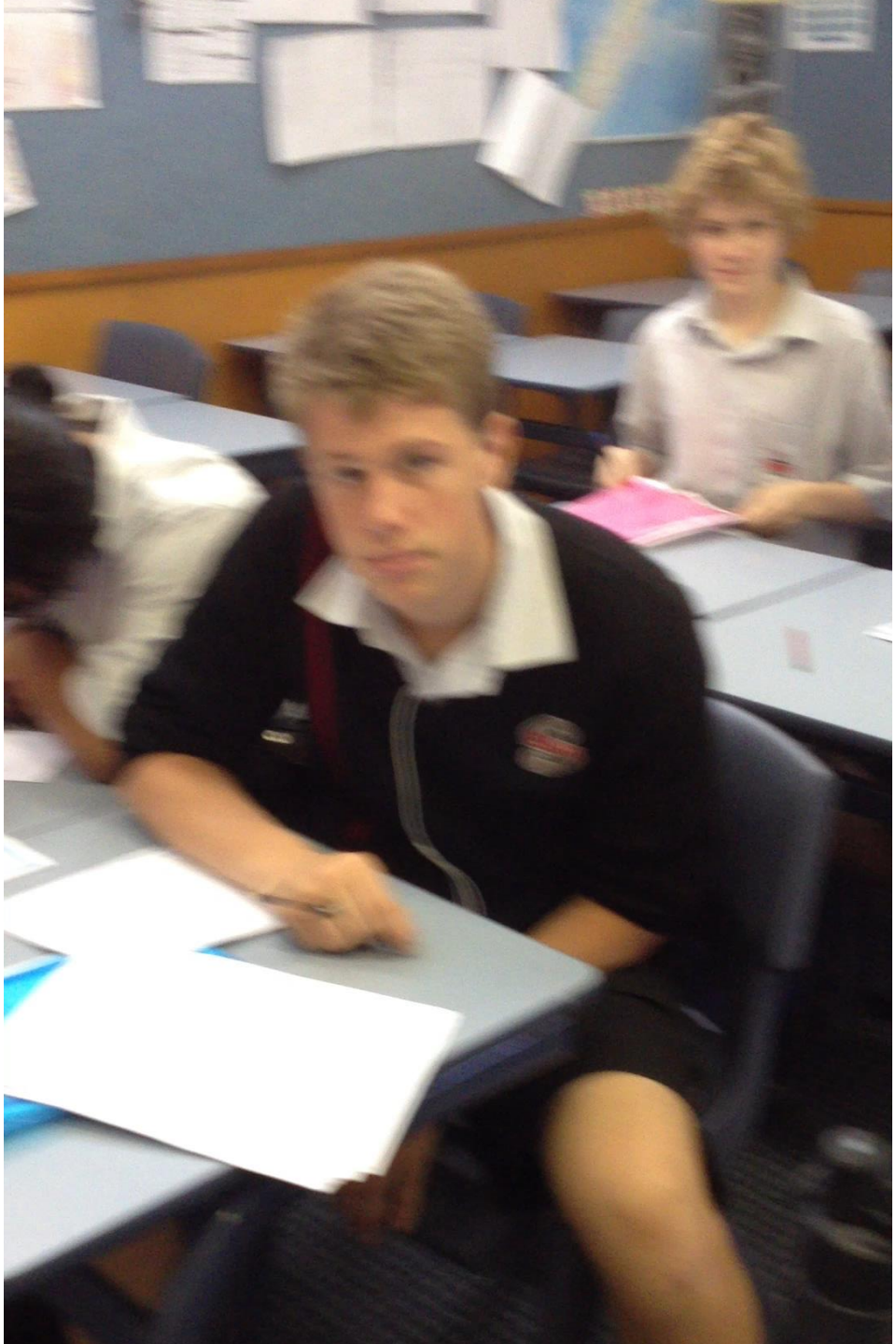
- More than 900 individuals being trained in FIE since July 2014.
- Anne Gaze: info@campslink.org
- Feuerstein Community of Practice Research Group. Mandia Mentis from Massey University and Joanne Walker from Auckland University provide support and guidance.
- Research at Royal Oak Intermediate School. Extension class – www.fieclass.com
- Research at Selwyn College. Dyslexia spectrum – www.selwynfie.com
- Numerous classes/groups/individual FIE sessions are in progress throughout NZ.

My FIE Journey in RTLB Cluster 8

- Completed FIE Standard Level 2
- Completed LPAD Level 2
- Completed two school terms teaching FIE Standard Level 1 at Selwyn College to year 9 and 10 students (12 in term 4, 2014 / 9 in term 1, 2015) on the Dyslexia Spectrum. Research project: www.selwynfie.com
- Working with several individual students (casework) FIE Standard Level 1 and 2

My FIE Journey in RTLB Cluster 8 (cont.)

- Started a small class (10, year 8 students who are below National Standards) at Glenbrae Primary School, teaching FIE Standard Level 1 and 2. Research project.
- Working with 2 individual students using LPAD.
- Supporting FIE implementation of FIE Standard Level 1 at a Kura in Glen Innes, Sacred Heart College, St. Michael's
- Advisory and consultation to several FIE trained individuals, schools (observation, planning, implementation, research, documentation).
- Planning to become a FIE Standard Trainer by mid – 2016.



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